SDP

No Instruments, No Delivery

The Enterprise Agentic Imperative

Agentic AI multiplies developer throughput — but only if you build the cockpit first.

Executive Talk · 45 minutes

A Three-Part Executive Briefing Series

The Labor Multiplier

What agents can actually do — the 67% of delivery labor outside the code editor that AI is built to handle at a fraction of human cost

Agentic Economics

How to calculate and capture ROI — agent compute costs, infrastructure investment requirements, and the honest payback math

Agentic Delivery

The operating model for safe scale — instrument infrastructure, pilot oversight, and the governance that enables the throughput multiplier

Each briefing is complete on its own. Together they form a full strategic framework for agentic AI investment.

Three Briefings, Three Decisions

The Labor Multiplier	Which of the 67% of delivery labor is ready to automate — and what organizational investment does capturing it require?	`Opportunity Decision`
Agentic Economics	What is the realistic ROI timeline, and what infrastructure makes the $2–5/hour agent arbitrage accessible at scale?	`Capital Decision`
Agentic Delivery	What governance infrastructure — instruments, oversight model, no-fly zones — must exist before agent programs can operate safely?	`Operating Model Decision`

These are the three decisions the briefing series is designed to drive. This talk addresses one of them.

The Complete Decision Framework

Identify the Opportunity

The Labor Multiplier: 67% of delivery labor has no AI coverage — discovery, compliance, documentation, and validation are ready for agents

Quantify the Investment

Agentic Economics: agent compute at $2–5/hour creates a structural cost arbitrage — the ROI depends on the verification infrastructure

Enable Safe Operation

Agentic Delivery: the instrument panel, pilot model, and governance structure that make the multiplier achievable at enterprise scale

💡 The Labor Multiplier identifies what is possible. Agentic Economics quantifies the return. Agentic Delivery specifies the infrastructure that makes both achievable.

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Business stakes and the reframe that changes the calculus for enterprise AI investment

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Roles, Instruments, Multiplier

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Liability Charter

Six governance categories, the ROI chain, and why mature DevSecOps is already the cockpit

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Three Named Asks

Named owners, timelines, and exactly what leadership is authorizing today

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PART 1

The Shift

The productivity opportunity is documented — the question is what it takes to capture it safely at enterprise scale

📊

The Signal

Only 5% of AI pilots deliver material bottom-line improvement

⚖️

The Stakes

$4.88M breach + SEC 4-day disclosure — liability startups avoid

✈️

The Reframe

Developers become captains — throughput follows the instruments

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executive briefing
↳ AI is already changing software delivery at measurable scale. The
question is whether an organization captures it safely.
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The 5% Signal

Only 5% of enterprise AI pilots deliver material bottom-line improvement. Governance infrastructure is the differentiator.

5%

of enterprise AI pilots deliver material bottom-line improvement

McKinsey QuantumBlack, State of AI 2024

✅ The RCT Evidence

GitHub 2022: 55% faster with AI. Accenture 2024: 84% more successful builds at enterprise scale.

🏗 What Separates the 5%

Automated verification infrastructure — the instrument panel that makes AI trustworthy at speed.

💡 The Implication

Governance infrastructure is the variable. Organizations that invest in it capture the full gain.

🎯 Organizations capturing AI value built the infrastructure to verify what the tools produce.

The Enterprise Stakes

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DORA 208× Gap

Elite teams deploy 208× more frequently with 3× lower failure rate — DORA 2023.

🛡️

$4.88M Breach Cost

IBM 2024: average enterprise data breach cost. AI-assisted detection saves $2.2M per incident.

📋

Regulatory Floor

SEC 4-day disclosure in force. EU AI Act 2025–2026. NIST AI RMF is the governance standard.

⚖️ Agentic AI without automated governance creates a new delivery liability category. The instrument panel is both the multiplier enabler and the liability defense.

From Coders to Captains

💻 Developer as Coder

- Lines of code written
- Typing speed
- Syntax knowledge
- Faster autocomplete

✈️ Developer as Captain

- Missions completed
- Instrument monitoring capacity
- Judgment and decision-making
- Autopilot — developer remains accountable

⚡ One developer supervising 3–4 concurrent agentic sessions converts a $10M organization into $20M of delivery capacity. The Flight Model shows the math.

PART 2

The Flight Model

Five roles, six instruments, and the authorization model that makes the multiplier achievable

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Five Roles

FAA to Autopilot — every enterprise role has a mapped position

🎛️

Six Instruments

Automated governance gates — each maps to an enterprise liability

⚡

The Math

One developer, 3–4 sessions — $20M capacity in a $10M org

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flight model
↳ Instrument monitoring capacity is the ceiling. The instrument panel
determines how many flights are safe.
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The Enterprise Flight System

Five roles — every organization already has most of them

FAA	Sets all rules — safety standards, enforcement, compliance	`CISO · Legal · Compliance`
Control Tower	Coordinates active flights — sequencing, routing, go/no-go decisions	`CTO · VP Engineering`
Ground Crew	Prepares instruments and infrastructure for every flight	`Platform Engineering · DevOps`
Captains	Plans the mission, makes judgment calls, lands safely, deploys code	`Developers`
Autopilot	Executes the mechanical work — code generation, test iteration, docs	`Agentic AI`

Most organizations have Captains and Autopilot. Ground Crew and the instrument panel are the missing components.

The Instrument Panel

Six governance gates — each provides a single traffic-light reading at deployment

Test Health	Automated test results gate every deployment — red grounds the flight	`Quality gate`
Security Scan	Vulnerability detection on every commit — $4.88M breach defense	`SAST / DAST`
Performance	Regression detection vs. production baseline — silent slowdowns caught	`Baseline guard`
Compliance	SOC 2, HIPAA, FedRAMP violations blocked at merge — not in audit	`Policy gate`
Deploy Window	Change management enforced automatically — no override, no exceptions	`Risk guard`
Dependencies	Supply chain CVE scan on every import — SolarWinds-class risk detected	`CVE gate`

Instrument coverage is the prerequisite for safe AI output verification at speed. The multiplier follows from the instrument panel.

Authorization and the Multiplier

✈️ The Authorization Model

- Human defines scope, acceptance criteria, limits — go/no-go decision
- Human initializes agent with bounded parameters and explicit constraints
- AI executes autonomously — developer monitors instrument panel
- Human reviews all output — all six instruments green before deploying

⚡ The Multiplier

- One developer monitors aggregated status across all active flights
- Throughput equivalent to tripling headcount without tripling payroll
- Not typing speed — the instrument panel determines how many flights are safe

💡 AI operates in one bounded phase. Humans control entry and exit. That authorization model is what makes 3–4 concurrent sessions governable at enterprise scale.

PART 3

The Risk

Six liability categories, the ROI chain, and why existing DevSecOps infrastructure is already the cockpit

⚖️

Governance Charter

Six AI actions requiring authorization — each with a dollar figure

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The CFO and CISO Case

$2.2M savings + $1→$6 ROI + EU AI Act and SEC timelines

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The Instrument Advantage

Mature DevSecOps orgs are completing a cockpit, not building one

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governance
↳ The instrument panel is flight clearance.
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The Governance Charter

Six categories of AI action requiring explicit human authorization — each with a liability citation

DB Schema	Schema changes are irreversible at scale — creates breach exposure	`$4.88M risk`
Security Ctrl	Bypassing a compliance check can trigger SEC 4-day disclosure	`SEC regulatory`
Dependencies	Supply chain trust — SolarWinds and Log4j establish the precedent	`Supply chain`
Prod Config	Runtime config shifts behavior as dramatically as code changes	`Deploy risk`
Access Ctrl	Privilege escalation breaks the trust model for automation	`Audit flag`
Integrations	New external connections need legal, security, and compliance sign-off	`Architecture`

These limits earn the agent broad autonomous authority within them. Governance boundaries are what make autonomy safe.

The CFO and CISO Case

💰 The CFO Frame

- IBM 2024 — before SEC disclosure obligations and regulatory fines
- IBM 2025 — with AI-assisted security detection in the instrument panel
- Every dollar in delivery automation returns $6 in reduced incident costs
- Protecting the ROI on AI spend already authorized

🛡️ The CISO Frame

- High-risk AI classification and conformity requirements — build now or build under regulatory audit
- Material cybersecurity incidents require disclosure within 4 business days
- Govern, Map, Measure, Manage — the enterprise AI governance vocabulary regulators use
- Organizations with existing automation are completing an instrument panel — a structural advantage.

🎯 Building governance infrastructure on the organization's own terms and timeline is the lower-cost path. Regulatory pressure makes it more expensive.

PART 4

The Decision

Three named asks, three owners, three timelines — what is being authorized today

Authorize the Audit

VP Engineering. Four weeks. Every gap is risk with open eyes.

Fund the Cockpit

3–5 platform engineers — enabling infrastructure, not overhead.

Designate Pilots

One team. 90 days. Baseline DORA metrics defined before launch.

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authorization
↳ Authorization here is an operating model decision, with named owners and
a 90-day proof structure.
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Action 1: Authorize a Platform Audit

What

Assess which of the six instruments the pipeline has. Each gap is a named ceiling on AI ROI.

Owner: VP Engineering

Leads the assessment with the delivery team. Results reported to leadership in four weeks.

Timeline: 4 Weeks

Every gap is risk accepted with open eyes — a ceiling on the AI investment already authorized.

🎯 This is the only ask with a hard deadline. Actions 2 and 3 depend on what this one finds.

Action 2: Fund the Instrument Panel

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What

A dedicated platform team wiring existing tooling and filling gaps identified in the audit.

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Investment: 3–5 Engineers

For a 50-developer organization. Scales to 500. Payback measured in weeks, not quarters.

📈

Return: $1 → $6

$1 in delivery automation returns $6 in reduced incident costs — IBM/Ponemon.

💡 The platform team is the capital decision that makes existing AI spend return value.

Action 3: Designate a Pilot Team

What

Select one team to operate with a complete instrument panel and structured agentic workflow.

Scope: 90-Day Pilot

Measure deployment frequency, failure rate, and cycle time — baseline before launch, data after.

Output: The Business Case

90-day DORA-anchored data is the board-ready case for scaling agentic delivery organization-wide.

Authorization here is an operating model decision. Start with one team. Measure everything. Scale what works.

📊 The Value Recap

The Instrument Panel Changes Everything

Before

- One developer, one agentic session — manual verification at every step
- AI-generated code ships without automated security or compliance checks
- Flying blind across more missions amplifies failures, not productivity
- Risk is invisible until incident — SEC 4-day clock starts after the breach

After

- One developer, 3–4 concurrent sessions with aggregated instrument status
- Automated gates on every commit — security, compliance, quality enforced
- Fleet-wide visibility — CTO/VP Engineering coordinates from the control tower
- Speed compounds advantage safely — 208× deployments, 3× lower failure rate

3–4×
developer throughput with a full instrument panel

$20M
delivery capacity unlocked in a $10M engineering org

6×
ROI on every dollar invested in delivery automation

✅ What You Can Do Today

Today

- Schedule the platform infrastructure audit with VP Engineering — four-week deadline, instrument gap map as the deliverable
- Identify which of the six instruments the delivery pipeline already has

This Week

- Designate a pilot team candidate and define baseline DORA metrics before agentic workflow begins
- Draft the platform team investment proposal — 3–5 engineers, specific gaps identified, payback timeline

This Month

- Fund and staff the platform team; begin closing the highest-risk instrument gaps first
- Pilot team completes first full agentic sprint with complete instrument monitoring active

🔑 Key Takeaway

The organizations that lead are those whose developers can safely fly the most planes.

References

AI Productivity Research

GitHub / Microsoft Research, 2022
Controlled study: developers complete tasks 55% faster with AI coding assistance

GitHub + Accenture RCT, 2024
Enterprise scale: 84% more successful builds; 70% less mental effort on repetitive tasks

McKinsey QuantumBlack: State of AI, 2024
Only 5% of AI pilots deliver material bottom-line improvement; organizational complexity is the primary barrier

METR RCT, 2025
Experienced developers took 19% longer on complex tasks with AI assistance — expected 20–39% speedup

Risk, Governance and Regulation

IBM Cost of a Data Breach, 2025
$4.88M average breach cost; AI-assisted detection saves $2.2M per incident

DevOps and Measurement

DORA State of DevOps, 2023
Elite teams deploy 208× more frequently with a 3× lower change failure rate

DORA: ROI of AI-Assisted Development, 2025
Framework linking AI engineering velocity to measurable financial outcomes

SDP

No Instruments, No Delivery

The Enterprise Agentic Imperative

5%	$20M	$2.2M
Deliver Material ROI	Capacity in a $10M Org	Per-Incident Savings
McKinsey 2024: the differentiator is governance infrastructure, not the tools	One developer, 3–4 concurrent sessions — limit is monitoring, not headcount	IBM 2025: AI-assisted security detection reduces breach cost by $2.2M per event

Which of the six instruments is the most critical gap in the delivery pipeline right now?